CB

CROWN BOOKS

USER GUIDE · EDITION 1.0

SIMPLE BOOKS FOR GROWING BUSINESSES

Crown Books

The user guide

Run the business.
We'll keep the books.

For billing and accounts staff

A step-by-step guide to parties, items, bills, invoices, receipts, payments, stock, reports and backups.

October 2026

Built around the Crown Traders example company

READ THIS FIRST

Your books, one step at a time

Crown Books keeps the accounts of one business on this computer. It answers three questions: who owes us, who do we owe, and do the books balance. This guide shows the actual screens and the buttons to press.

01

Who owes us?
Sales invoices, receipts, receivables and ageing.

02

Who do we owe?
Purchase bills, payments, payables and due dates.

03

Do the books balance?
Trial balance, profit and loss, and the balance sheet.

Before you start

- [ ] Business name, address, state and GSTIN.
- [ ] Owner name, email and a password of at least 8 characters.
- [ ] The date your books should begin.
- [ ] Customer and supplier list, with phone and GSTIN where known.
- [ ] Item list with HSN or SAC, unit, GST rate, sale and purchase price.
- [ ] Opening stock, party balances and cash or bank balances.

How to read a step

Button and field names appear in **bold** exactly as they appear on screen. Numbers and voucher numbers appear in `monospace`.

A red number on a screenshot matches a numbered step or key beside it. Reference figures use the key printed under the picture.

> **TIP**
> Do one chapter at a time. The first five steps in chapter 1 are enough to post your first invoice. Everything else can wait until you need it.

> **THE ONE RULE THAT PREVENTS MOST MISTAKES**
> **Nothing is saved until you press Post.** Closing the screen or pressing Cancel discards the entry. A posted voucher is never edited: cancel it with a reason and enter a new one.

How the pieces fit

MASTERS
Who and what
Company, parties, items, accounts.

→

VOUCHERS
What happened
Bills, invoices, receipts, payments, journals.

→

REPORTS
What it means
Trial balance, profit and loss, balance sheet.

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10 chapters · 30 figures

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09 **Backup and safety** 30
Create, restore and store a backup safely.

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Shortcuts, series, messages, glossary, routines.

The guide uses the Crown Traders example company, so names and amounts in the screenshots will differ from your own books. Figures are numbered by chapter, for example Figure 6.2.

Start by situation

A

New business

Chapter 1, then 2.1, 3, 4 and 6. Skip opening balances unless you already have stock or dues.

B

Moving from Tally or QuickBooks

Read 2.2 and 2.4 first. Bring the closing balances and open bills, then continue at chapter 5.

C

Daily billing clerk

Chapter 6 for sales, 5 for purchases, 8 for reports, and 9 for the end-of-day backup.

Your first path through the book

01 **Set up**
Company, books begin, parties and items.

→

02 **Buy**
Post a purchase bill and pay the supplier.

→

03 **Sell**
Post an invoice, print it, record the receipt.

→

04 **Check**
Trial balance, profit and loss, backup.

TEN MINUTES

Read 1.2, 1.5, 3.2, 4.2, 5.2 and 6.2, then post one purchase and one sale. That is enough to understand the whole application.

01 Start here

Open the app, create the company, sign in, and learn the one pattern every voucher follows. By the end of this chapter you will know where everything lives.

IN THIS CHAPTER Open · First run · Sign in · The screen · Voucher anatomy · First five steps

1.1 Open the app

Crown Books is installed on this computer. Open it from the Start menu or the desktop shortcut. The app checks that this computer is the one the books were installed for. If you see **"This computer is not authorised"**, stop and contact your administrator; the application is not designed to be copied to another machine.

There is no internet connection, no cloud account and no website sign-in. Everything is stored in a local database file on this computer.

1.2 First-run setup

The first time the app opens, it asks for the company and the owner account. This happens once. You can change the company details later in **Admin → Company**.

1. **Business name, owner name and phone.** The name is printed on invoices; the owner is the first user and can do everything.
2. **Owner email.** This becomes your sign-in name. Use an address you check.
3. **Password.** At least 8 characters, stored hashed on this machine. There is no "forgot password" email; keep it somewhere safe.
4. **State and GSTIN.** The state decides CGST + SGST or IGST. Enter the GSTIN exactly as registered, without spaces.
5. **Books begin.** The first day Crown Books records transactions. Read 2.2 before choosing a mid-year date.
6. Click **Create company and sign in**.

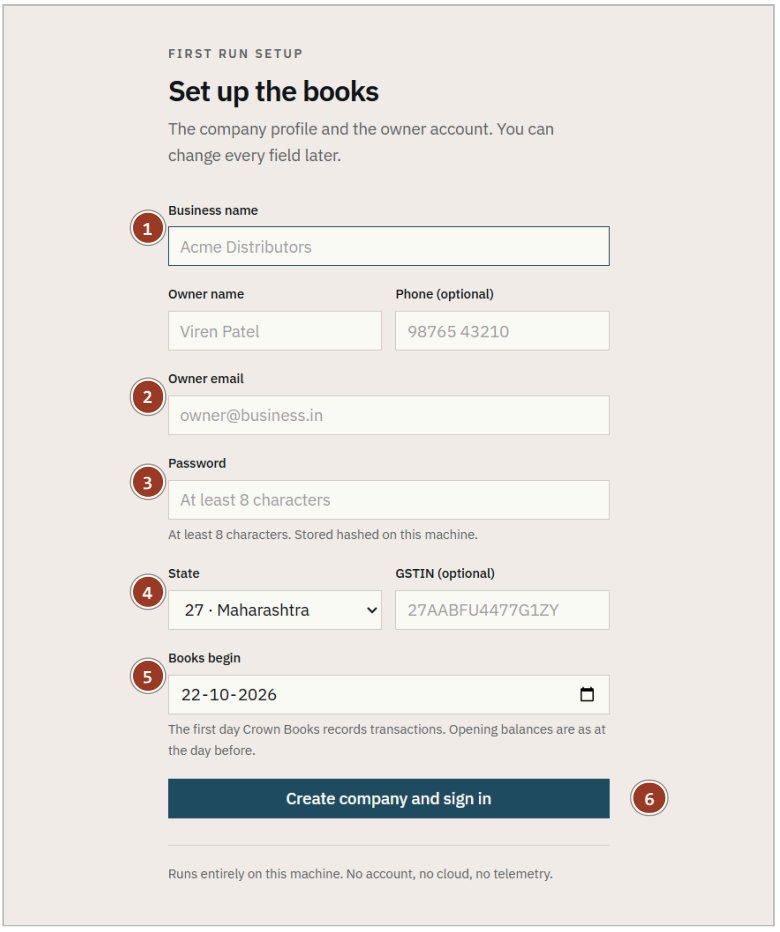


Figure 1.1 The first-run screen. The company and owner are created together.

> **BOOKS BEGIN IS NOT THE FINANCIAL YEAR**
> The financial year is the reporting period, usually 1 April to 31 March. Books begin is the day this app starts keeping the ledger. Starting fresh on 1 April? Both dates can be 1 April. Migrating in October? Books begin is the day after your last entry in the old system; the financial year is still the current April-to-March year.

1.3 Sign in again

After setup, every launch shows the sign-in screen. Enter the owner email and password and click **Sign in**. To leave, open the account menu at the top right and choose **Sign out**. Closing the window is also safe: every posted voucher is already in the database.

1.4 The screen

Every page has the same frame: a dark navigation rail on the left, a thin top bar, and the page itself. The rail is grouped by the work you are doing, not by database tables.

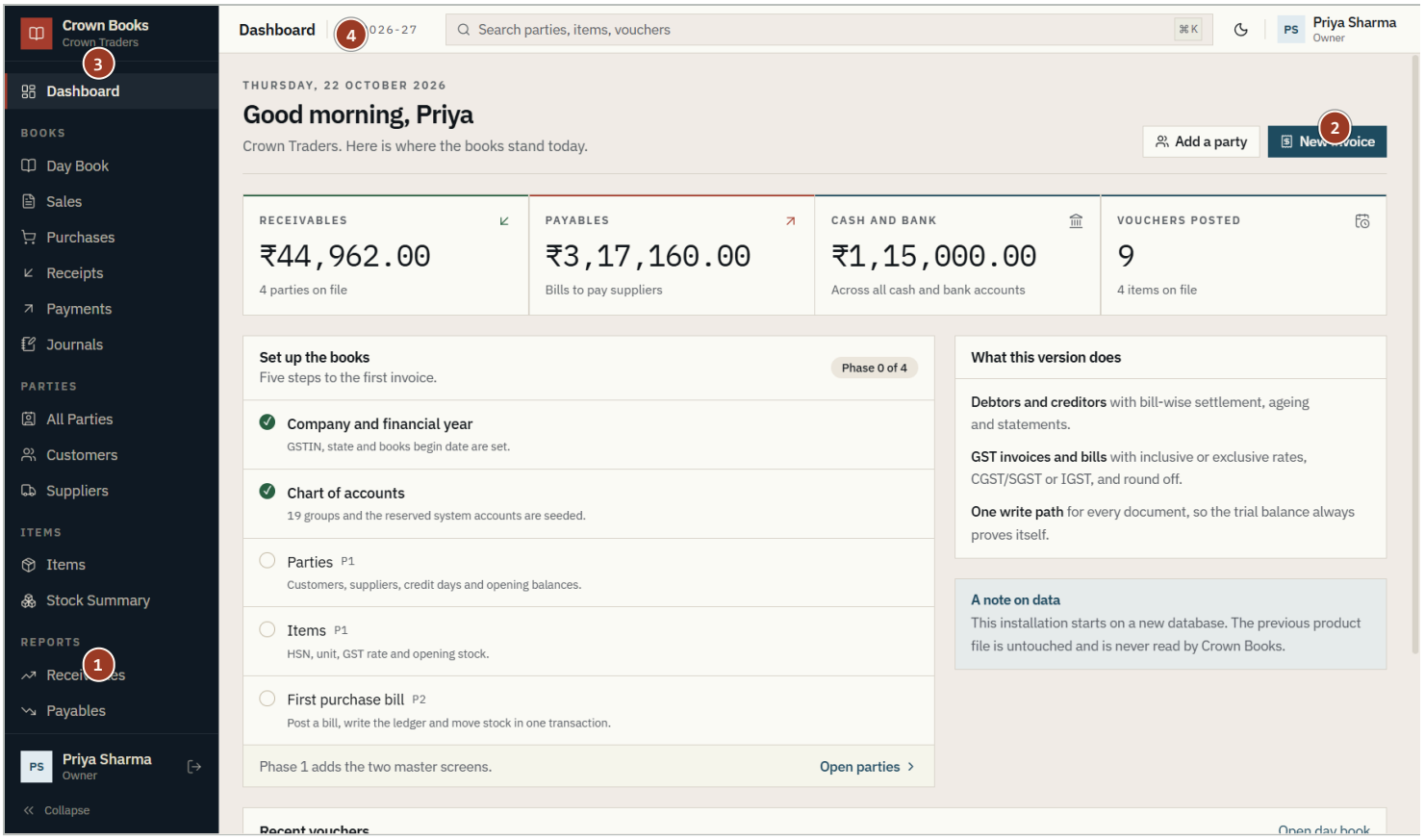


Figure 1.2 The dashboard for Crown Traders, with the navigation rail and the four headline numbers.

1. Four numbers for today
2. Quick actions
3. The modules live in this rail
4. Current financial year and account

RAIL GROUP	WHAT IT IS FOR
Dashboard	Receivables, payables, cash and bank, and vouchers posted.
Books	Day Book, Sales, Purchases, Receipts, Payments and Journals: the documents.
Parties	All Parties, Customers and Suppliers. One record per business.
Items	Items and Stock Summary: goods, services and what is on hand.
Reports	Receivables, Payables, Ageing, Trial Balance, Profit and Loss, Balance Sheet.
Masters	Chart of Accounts. Tax Rates and Units are reserved for a later edition.
Admin	Company, Users and Roles (reserved), and Backup.

The top bar shows the page name, the current financial year, and your account. The theme button switches between the paper and dark palettes. The search box in the top bar is reserved; use the search field on each page instead.

1.5 The anatomy of a voucher

A voucher is any document that changes the books: an invoice, a bill, a receipt, a payment, a journal or a contra. Every entry screen uses the same four-part pattern. Once you know one, you know all of them.

01
Header
Party, date, due date, reference and place of supply.

→

02
Lines
Item, description, quantity, rate, discount and GST.

→

03
Totals
Taxable value, tax, round off and the final total.

→

04
Post
The server checks, numbers and writes the voucher.

1.6 Your first five steps

For a complete cycle, do these five things in order. The rest of the guide explains each one in detail.

1. **Create the company** in first-run setup. Use 1 April as books begin if you are starting a fresh year.
2. **Add a customer and a supplier** under Parties. One record each is enough to begin.
3. **Add one item** under Items. Enter its HSN, GST rate and sale price.
4. **Post a purchase bill** under Purchases. This brings stock in and creates the supplier payable.
5. **Post a sales invoice** under Sales. Then open it and click **Print**.

1.7 Where do I…?

Every task starts from the navigation rail. This is the short version.

I WANT TO…	GO TO
Record a sale	**Books → Sales → New invoice**
Record a purchase	**Books → Purchases → New bill**
Record a receipt	**Books → Receipts → New receipt**
Pay a supplier	**Books → Payments → New payment**
Find a voucher	**Books → Day Book**, or search on the page
Add a customer or supplier	**Parties → All Parties → New party**
Add an item	**Items → Items → New item**
Check who owes you	**Reports → Receivables** or **Ageing**
Check that the books balance	**Reports → Trial Balance**
Back up	**Admin → Backup → Create backup**

02 Company and opening balances

The company profile is printed on every document. The chart of accounts is the list of ledgers behind the reports. Opening balances are the one-time bridge from your old books.

IN THIS CHAPTER Company settings · Books begin · Chart of accounts · Opening balances

2.1 Company settings

Open **Admin** → **Company**. The page has four sections: identity, financial year, stock and rounding, and invoice terms. The first two are printed on documents; the last two control costing and rounding.

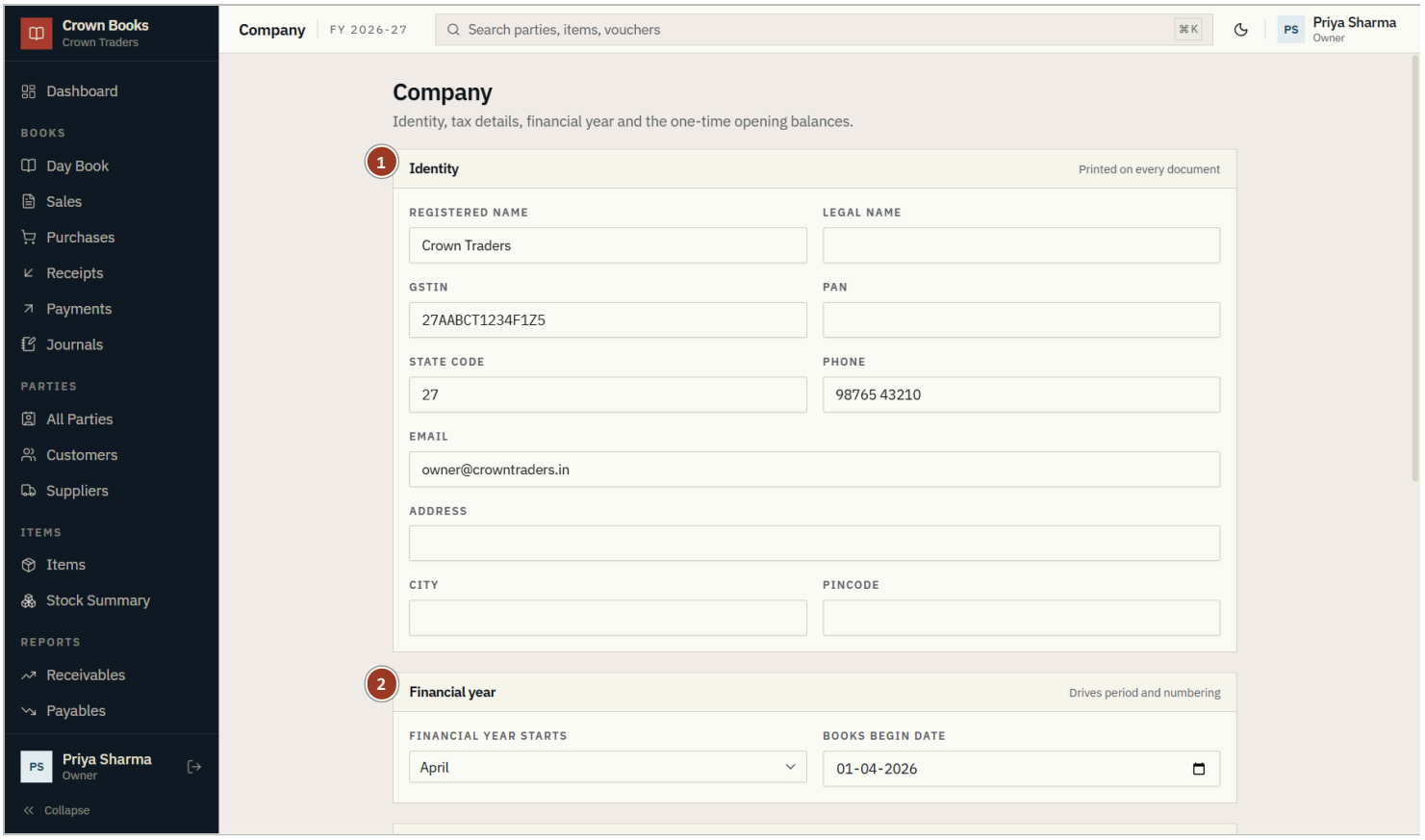


Figure 2.1 Company settings. Identity is printed on documents; the financial year drives numbering and reports.

1 Identity printed on invoices

2 Financial year and books begin

Registered name
The name printed on invoices, usually the legal or trading name.

Address, city, pincode
The address printed above the invoice lines.

Books begin date
The first day this app records transactions. See 2.2.

Round off
How the invoice total is rounded. **Invoice total** is the usual choice.

GSTIN, PAN, state code
Registration details. The state code is two digits, for example 27 for Maharashtra.

Financial year starts
The month your reporting year starts. April is the default for India.

Costing method
Keep **Weighted average**. This edition values stock at weighted average cost.

Default terms
Saved with the company, but not printed by the current invoice layout.

LEAVE THIS UNTICKED

Allow selling below stock on hand is recorded as a setting but the current build does not enforce a stock guard. Keep it unticked and check the stock summary before a large sale.

2.2 What “books begin” means

Books begin is the first day Crown Books is responsible for the ledger. Before that date, the history lives in your old system, your accountant’s file, or nowhere. At that date you bring in one opening position: what you own, what you owe, and what customers owe you.

It is not the financial year. A business can have a financial year from 1 April to 31 March and still begin its Crown Books ledger on 1 October after migrating from Tally. An October invoice still belongs to the current April-to-March year.

SITUATION	WHAT TO ENTER
Starting a new business	The day you want the books to start, often 1 April or the day of the first sale.
Fresh financial year	1 April of that year. Opening balances are the previous 31 March closing balances.
Migrating mid-year	The day after the last entry in the old system. Opening balances are as at the close of the day before.
Only using Crown Books for sales	Still use the real start date. Do not enter a later date just to avoid old data.

> **OPENING BALANCES ARE THE DAY BEFORE**
> If the old system is closed on 30 September and books begin is 1 October, the opening balances are the position at the close of 30 September. Post the opening voucher dated 1 October, then start entering October transactions.

2.3 Chart of accounts

Every voucher writes to ledgers. The chart of accounts is the list of those ledgers, grouped into assets, liabilities, equity, income and expenses. Crown Books seeds a working set so you do not have to create one from scratch.

1. Click **New account**.
2. Enter a **Name**, for example Office Expenses.
3. Choose a **Group**. It decides the nature, for example Indirect Expenses.
4. Check the **Type**. It follows the group but can be adjusted.
5. Leave the opening balance at zero unless you are setting up the opening position.
6. Click **Add account**.

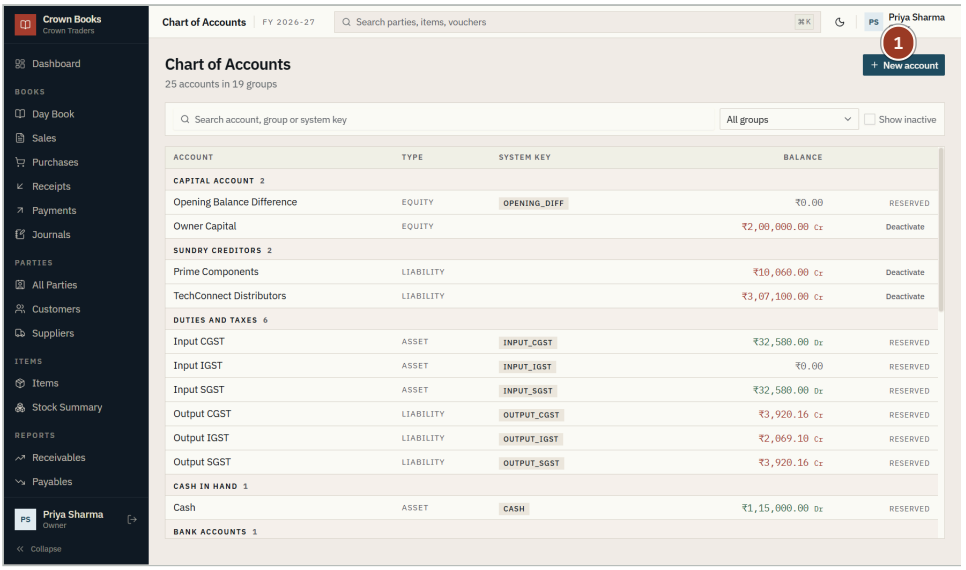


Figure 2.2 The chart of accounts. Rows marked Reserved are used by the posting engine and cannot be deactivated.

Reserved ledgers have a fixed job: sales, purchases, GST, inventory, cost of goods sold, round off and the opening difference. Add your own ledgers for rent, salaries or travel without touching them.

2.4 Opening balances

Opening balances come from three places: the party record, the account record and the item record. They are collected into one opening voucher so that the trial balance stays balanced.

1. Add party opening balances in the party records. Positive means the party owes you; negative means you owe the party.
2. Add the opening balance and side on each bank, cash, loan or capital account.
3. Add opening quantity and rate on each goods item. Services do not hold stock.
4. Open **Admin** → **Company**, scroll to **Opening balances**, and choose the **Opening date**.
5. Click **Post opening balances**. One `OPN/0001` voucher is created.
6. Open the trial balance and check that debits equal credits.

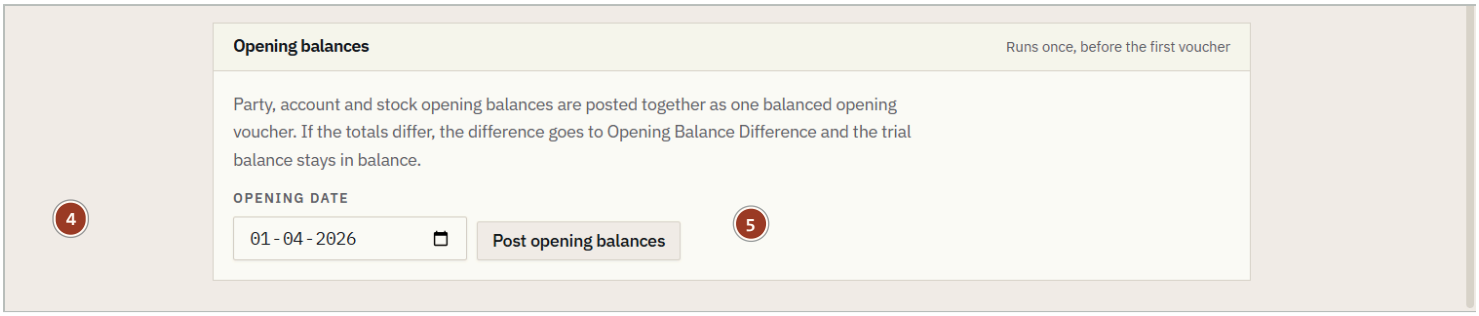


Figure 2.3 The opening balances section. It runs once, before the first real voucher.

2.5 Opening balance checklist

- [ ] The old system is closed and reconciled on the day before books begin.
- [ ] Every customer and supplier balance has the correct Dr or Cr side.
- [ ] Cash, bank, loans and capital are entered on the account records.
- [ ] Goods have opening quantity and rate, or zero if you are bringing purchase history.
- [ ] The opening date matches the day before the first new transaction.
- [ ] The trial balance says “Debits equal credits” and Opening Balance Difference is zero or explained.

After the opening voucher is posted, the opening fields are locked. Corrections go through a journal, not by editing the voucher.

03 Customers and suppliers

One record per business. The same business can be a customer and a supplier. The balance column tells you whether they owe you or you owe them.

IN THIS CHAPTER One record per business · Create a party · Edit and deactivate · Read the list · Credit terms

3.1 One record per business

A party is a customer, a supplier, or both. Use one record for a business even if you buy from and sell to them. The role is chosen when the party is created and is not changed later, because the role decides which ledger accounts the party uses.

The balance is shown as **Dr** or **Cr**. For a customer, Dr means they owe you. For a supplier, Cr means you owe them. A negative customer balance or a positive supplier balance is possible after an advance or an overpayment; it is not automatically an error.

3.2 Create a party

Open **Parties** → **All Parties** and click **New party**.



1 Click **Parties** in the sidebar, then **All Parties**. 2 Click **New party**.

1. **Name.** The trading name you will recognise in lists, for example Gupta Traders.
2. **Phone and Email.** Optional, but useful when chasing a bill.
3. **GSTIN** and **State code.** 15 characters and two digits. The state decides CGST + SGST or IGST on a sale.
4. **Credit days** and **Credit limit.** 30 means the invoice is due 30 days after the invoice date.
5. **Opening balance.** Positive if the party owes you, negative if you owe the party. Fixed after saving.
6. **Role.** Customer, Supplier, or both. Fixed after saving.
7. Click **Add party**.

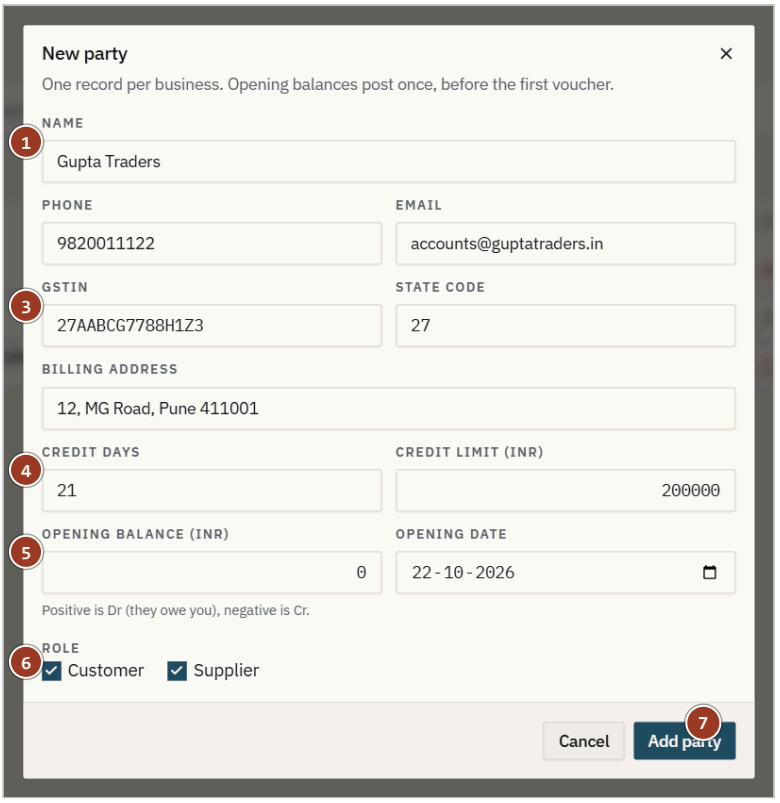


Figure 3.1 The New party form, filled for a business that is both a customer and a supplier.

3.3 Edit and deactivate

Use **Edit** on a row to correct a phone number, address, credit days or credit limit. The role and the opening balance are fixed after the party is created. If a party is no longer used, click **Deactivate**: the history stays in the books, and the party stops appearing in new-entry lists.

> **TIP**
> Deactivate a party instead of renaming it to "OLD". Reports and old vouchers keep the original name and history, and the list stays readable.

3.4 Read the party list

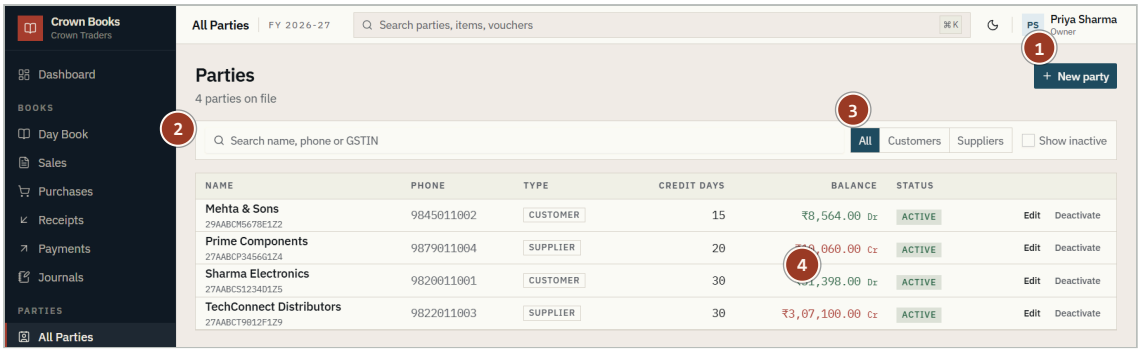


Figure 3.2 The parties list. The balance column is the net position across all posted vouchers.

1. Create a customer or supplier
2. Search by name, phone or GSTIN
3. Filter by role
4. Net balance: Dr means they owe you

Search matches name, phone and GSTIN. The role buttons filter to All, Customers or Suppliers. **Show inactive** reveals deactivated records. The **Credit days** column is the default payment term, not the age of the current balance.

3.5 Credit days and credit limit

Credit days are copied to the due date when you choose the party on an invoice. You can change the due date for an individual invoice. Ageing reports use the due date by default, so a wrong credit term makes a bill look overdue earlier or later than it really is.

Credit limit is a reference figure for your team. In this edition it does not stop an invoice from being posted. If a customer is near the limit, the person entering the sale must check.

ROLE	USE IT WHEN
Customer	You sell to them. They appear in Sales and Receivables.
Supplier	You buy from them. They appear in Purchases and Payables.
Both	You buy and sell to the same business. One record keeps the net balance in one place.

04 Items and stock

An item is anything you buy or sell: a physical product with stock, or a service with no stock. The item carries the HSN or SAC, the unit, the GST rate and the default prices.

IN THIS CHAPTER Goods and services · Create an item · Opening stock · Item list · Stock summary · How stock moves

4.1 Goods and services

A **goods item** carries stock. Buying it increases quantity, selling it decreases quantity, and the stock summary shows what is left. A **service item** has no stock; it is used for maintenance, consulting or any other work billed by quantity, hours or a flat rate.

4.2 Create an item

Open **Items** → **Items** and click **New item**.



1 Click **Items** in the sidebar, then **Items**. 2 Click **New item**.

1. **Name** and **SKU.** The name appears on the invoice; the SKU is your internal code.
2. **HSN / SAC.** The GST classification. Goods use HSN, services use SAC.
3. **Unit** and **GST rate.** 0, 5, 12, 18 or 28 percent. The rate is copied to a new invoice line but can be changed there.
4. **Service item (no stock).** Tick for services.
5. **Sale price** and **Purchase price.** Defaults, not locked prices.
6. **Opening qty** and **Opening rate.** Only for goods you already hold. Fixed after saving.
7. **Reorder level.** A reference for purchasing; it does not create an alert in this edition.
8. Click **Add item**.

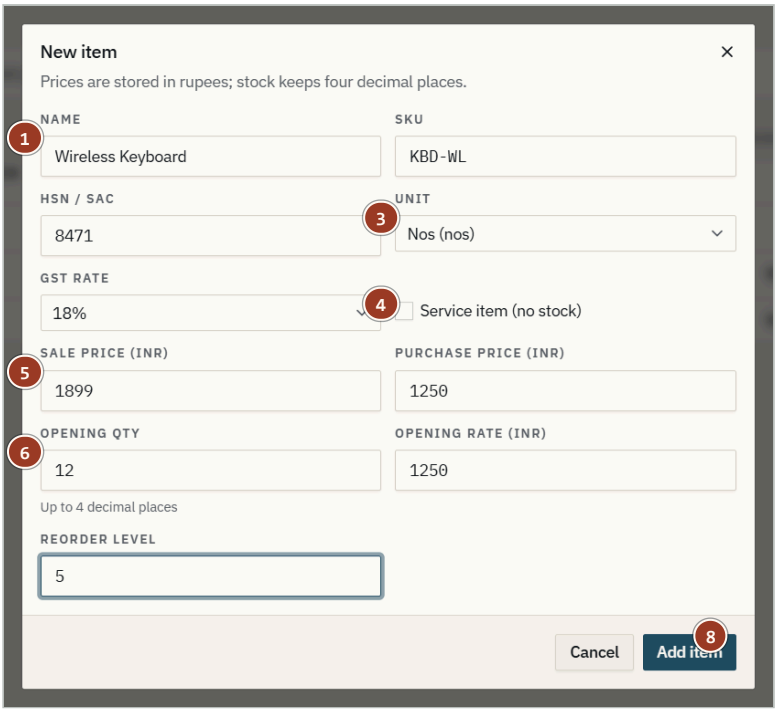


Figure 4.1 The New item form, filled for a goods item with opening stock.

4.3 Opening stock

Opening quantity and rate are included in the one-time opening voucher. They are not a purchase bill. If you enter opening stock and then also enter a purchase bill for the same goods, stock and cost will be counted twice.

> **CHOOSE ONE METHOD**
>
> **Opening stock only:** enter what you hold now and start buying from today. **Full purchase history:** leave opening stock at zero and enter the old purchase bills. Do not mix the two for the same goods.

4.4 The item list

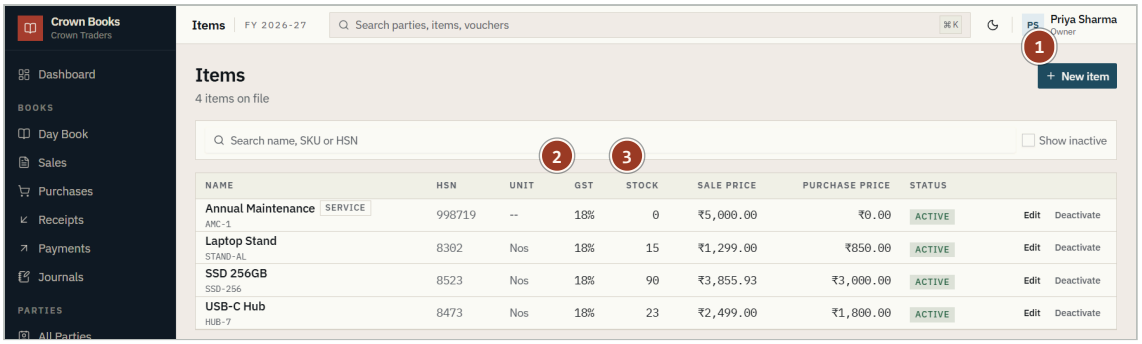


Figure 4.2 The item list. Stock and prices are shown per item; service items are tagged.

1. Create a goods or service item
2. HSN or SAC and GST rate
3. Quantity on hand, from posted movements

The list shows HSN or SAC, unit, GST rate, stock on hand, sale price and purchase price. Use the search box for name, SKU or HSN. **Edit** changes the descriptive fields and default prices; opening quantity and rate stay fixed. **Deactivate** hides an item from new entries without deleting history.

4.5 Stock summary

Open **Items** → **Stock Summary**. This is a computed report, not a data-entry screen. It reads every posted purchase, sale and return.

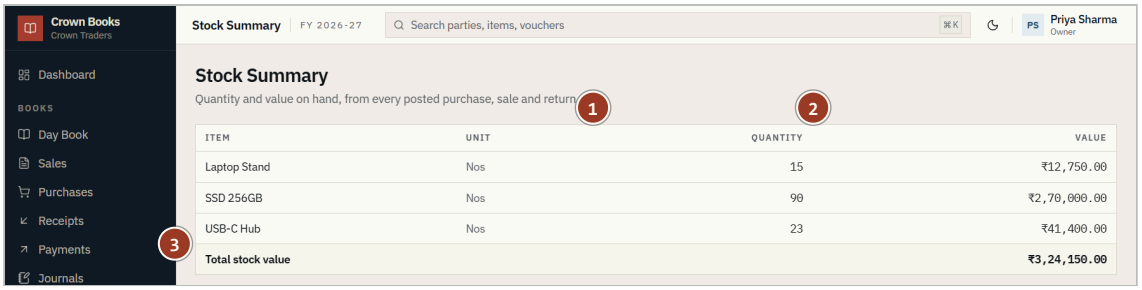


Figure 4.3 Stock on hand by item, with quantity and value at weighted average cost.

1. Quantity after every posted movement
2. Value at weighted average cost
3. Total stock value

Quantity is what is left. Value is quantity multiplied by the weighted average cost of the item. The total at the bottom is the inventory value that appears on the balance sheet. Services are not shown because they hold no stock.

4.6 How stock moves

ACTION	EFFECT ON STOCK	EFFECT ON THE BOOKS
Post a purchase bill	Quantity increases.	Creditor increases, inventory increases, input GST is recorded.
Post a sales invoice	Quantity decreases.	Customer owes you, sales and output GST increase, cost of goods sold is recorded.
Cancel a purchase or sale	The original movement is reversed.	The ledger effect is reversed; the voucher stays with status Cancelled.
Enter opening stock	Quantity starts at the opening figure.	Inventory and the opening difference are recorded once.

> **WHY THE STOCK VALUE CAN CHANGE WITHOUT A NEW PURCHASE**
>
> The costing method is weighted average. When a new purchase arrives at a different rate, the average cost of the remaining stock changes, so the value of the same quantity can move.

05 Buying: bills and payments

A purchase bill brings stock in and creates what you owe the supplier. A payment reduces that balance. The payables report tells you what is still open and when it is due.

IN THIS CHAPTER The buying flow · New purchase bill · What posting does · Pay a supplier · Payables · Purchase register

5.1 The buying flow

01	→	02	→	03
Purchase bill Stock comes in. The supplier becomes a creditor.		**Payment** Money goes out. Allocate it to the bill it settles.		**Payables** What is still owed, split into not due and overdue.

5.2 New purchase bill

Open **Books** → **Purchases** and click **New bill**. The screen is a bill, not a payment. Enter what the supplier billed you.



1 Click **Purchases** in the sidebar. **2** Click **New bill**.

1. **Party.** Choose the supplier. The list shows the current balance and credit days.
2. **Date** and **Due date.** The bill date decides the financial year and the register period. The due date fills from credit days.
3. **Reference.** The supplier's bill number, for example `TC/26-27/604`.
4. **Place of supply.** The supplier's state. Same state gives CGST + SGST; a different state gives IGST.
5. **Add line** for each item. Choose the item or type a free-text description.
6. Enter **Qty**, **Rate**, **Disc %** and **GST %**. HSN and unit fill from the item.
7. Check **Taxable value**, the tax split, **Round off** and **Total**.
8. Add a **Narration** that will make sense in six months.
9. Click **Post bill**. The number, for example `PUR/0001`, is assigned at that moment.

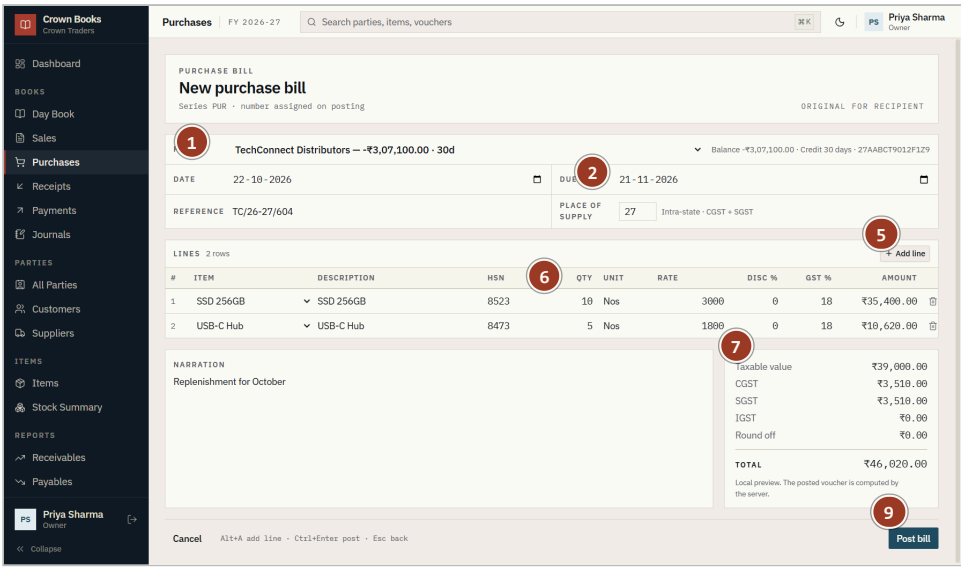


Figure 5.1 A new purchase bill with two item lines. The total is calculated before posting.

5.3 What posting does

- The supplier's payable increases by the bill total.
- Inventory increases by the taxable value of goods lines; services post to the expense or purchase ledger without stock.
- Input CGST, SGST or IGST is recorded according to the place of supply.
- The voucher gets a permanent number and appears in the purchase register and payables.

To print the posted bill, open it from **Purchases** and click **Print**. The print dialog also offers **Save as PDF**.

> **THE BILL IS NOT THE PAYMENT**
> Posting a purchase bill does not move money. It records the obligation. Use a payment voucher when the money actually leaves.

5.4 Pay a supplier

Open **Books** → **Payments** and click **New payment**. A payment can settle one bill, several bills, or stay on account as an advance.



1 Click **Payments** in the sidebar. 2 Click **New payment**.

1. **Party.** Choose the supplier. The screen shows the current balance.
2. **Date.** The date money left, not the bill date.
3. **Amount.** The total paid, for example 25,000.
4. **Method** and **Reference.** NEFT, UPI, cheque or cash, and the bank reference.
5. **Open bills** lists unpaid bills with due dates and outstanding amounts.
6. Enter the amount against the bill in **Allocate**. Leave the rest unallocated if it is an advance.
7. Check **Paid**, **Allocated** and **On account** at the bottom.
8. Click **Post payment**.

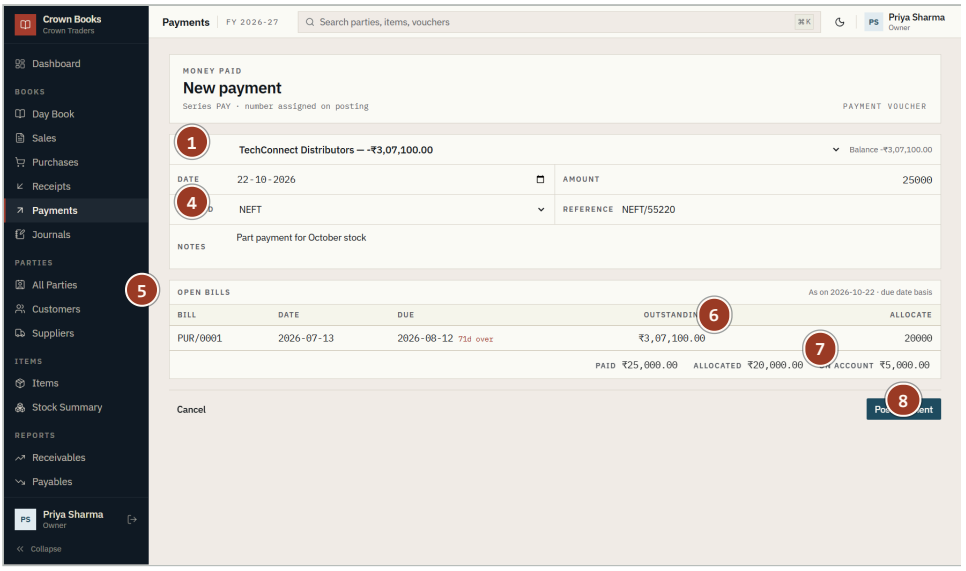


Figure 5.2 A supplier payment. The amount is 25,000, of which 20,000 is allocated to PUR/0001.

SITUATION	WHAT TO DO
Pay one bill in full	Allocate the full outstanding amount to that bill.
Part payment	Allocate less than the outstanding. The rest stays open.
Pay several bills	Enter an allocation against each bill in the same payment.
Advance	Leave the allocation blank. The money sits on account until a bill arrives.
Pay more than the bill	Allocate the bill amount and leave the excess on account.

> **CASH AND BANK IN THIS EDITION**
>
> Receipts and payments post to the Cash ledger. The **Method** list is a label on the entry screen. To move money between cash and bank, use **Journals** → **New contra** after the receipt or payment. Bank reconciliation is not part of this edition.

5.5 Payables

Open **Reports** → **Payables**. The report shows who you owe, split into amounts not yet due and amounts past the due date.

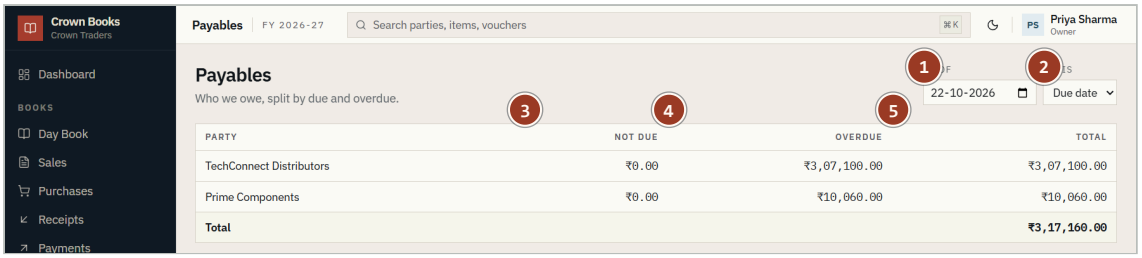


Figure 5.3 Payables as on 22 October 2026. Both suppliers are past their due dates in this example.

1. As-of date
2. Due date or bill date basis
3. Not yet due
4. Past the due date
5. Supplier total

As of is the date you are looking at. **Basis** decides whether a bill is measured by its bill date or its due date. Use **Due date** for collection and payment planning; use **Bill date** when you want the age of the document.

5.6 Purchase register

Open **Reports** → **Purchase Register**. It lists every purchase bill in the period with taxable value, GST, round off and total.

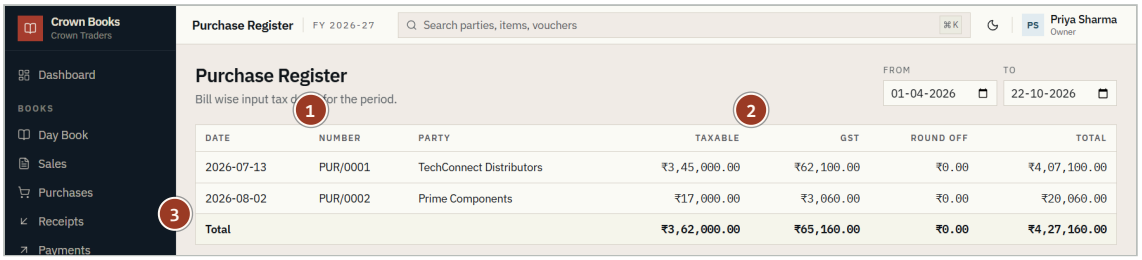


Figure 5.4 The purchase register for the financial year. Totals at the bottom tie to the purchase ledger.

1. Every purchase bill in the period
2. Input GST for the period
3. Totals to tie to the books

06 Selling: invoices and receipts

An invoice records what a customer owes. A receipt records what they paid. Receivables and ageing tell you who to chase and how old the bill is.

IN THIS CHAPTER The selling flow · New invoice · GST and place of supply · Print · Receipt · Receivables and ageing · Sales register

6.1 The selling flow

01	→	02	→	03
Sales invoice Customer owes you. Stock goes out. GST is recorded.		**Receipt** Money comes in. Allocate it to the invoice it settles.		**Receivables** What is still owed, with ageing and due dates.

6.2 New sales invoice

Open **Books** → **Sales** and click **New invoice**. Every sale is against a customer; a cash sale is recorded as an invoice followed by a receipt.



1 Click **Sales** in the sidebar. 2 Click **New invoice**.

1. **Party.** Choose the customer. The screen shows their balance, credit days and GSTIN.
2. **Date** and **Due date.** The invoice date decides the financial year and the sales register.
3. **Place of supply.** The customer's state. Same state as your company gives CGST + SGST; a different state gives IGST.
4. **Add line** for each item. Choose the saved item or type a free-text description.
5. Enter **Qty**, **Rate**, **Disc %** and **GST %**.
6. Check the totals and add a **Narration**.
7. Click **Post invoice**. The number, for example `INV/0001`, is assigned on posting.

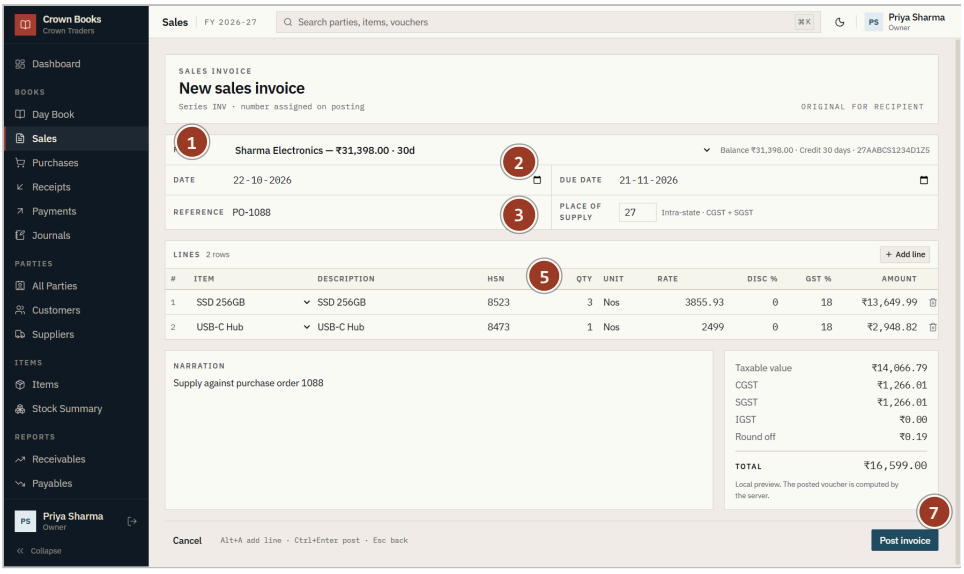


Figure 6.1 A new sales invoice for a Maharashtra customer, so the tax is CGST + SGST.

PLACE OF SUPPLY IS THE MOST COMMON GST MISTAKE

The place of supply defaults to your company's state. For an out-of-state customer, change it to the customer's state before posting. If you leave it on your own state, the invoice will charge CGST + SGST instead of IGST and the GST return will be wrong.

6.3 GST and place of supply

GST is charged per line. The place of supply decides how the same 18 percent is split.

PLACE OF SUPPLY	WHAT IS CHARGED	EXAMPLE
Same state as the company	CGST + SGST, half the rate each.	Company in 27 (Maharashtra), customer in 27. 18% becomes 9% CGST + 9% SGST.
Different state	IGST at the full rate.	Company in 27, customer in 29 (Karnataka). 18% becomes 18% IGST.

The tax is calculated on the taxable value after the line discount. The total is rounded according to the company setting, usually at the invoice total. The summary on the right shows taxable value, CGST, SGST, IGST, round off and total before you post.

6.4 Print or save the invoice

Open **Sales**, click the invoice number, and use **Print**. In the system print dialog, choose a printer or **Save as PDF**. The printed page carries the company name and GSTIN, the customer, the invoice number and date, the line items with HSN, the tax split and the total.

Crown Traders
GSTIN 27AABCT1234F1Z5 · 98765 43210

TAX INVOICE
INV/0001
11 Sept 2026 · due 11 Oct 2026 · ref PO-1042

POSTED
Sharma Electronics
GSTIN 27AABCS1234D1Z5

#	DESCRIPTION	QTY	RATE	DISC	GST	TAXABLE	TAX	AMOUNT
1	SSD 256GB HSN 8523	10 Nos	₹3,855.93	0%	18%	₹38,559.30	₹6,940.68	₹45,499.98
2	USB-C Hub HSN 8473	2 Nos	₹2,499.00	0%	18%	₹4,998.00	₹899.64	₹5,897.64

NARRATION
Supply of storage and accessories

Taxable value	₹43,557.30
CGST	₹3,920.16
SGST	₹3,920.16
Round off	₹0.38
TOTAL	₹51,398.00

Figure 6.2 What the printed invoice looks like. The navigation and top bar are hidden on paper.

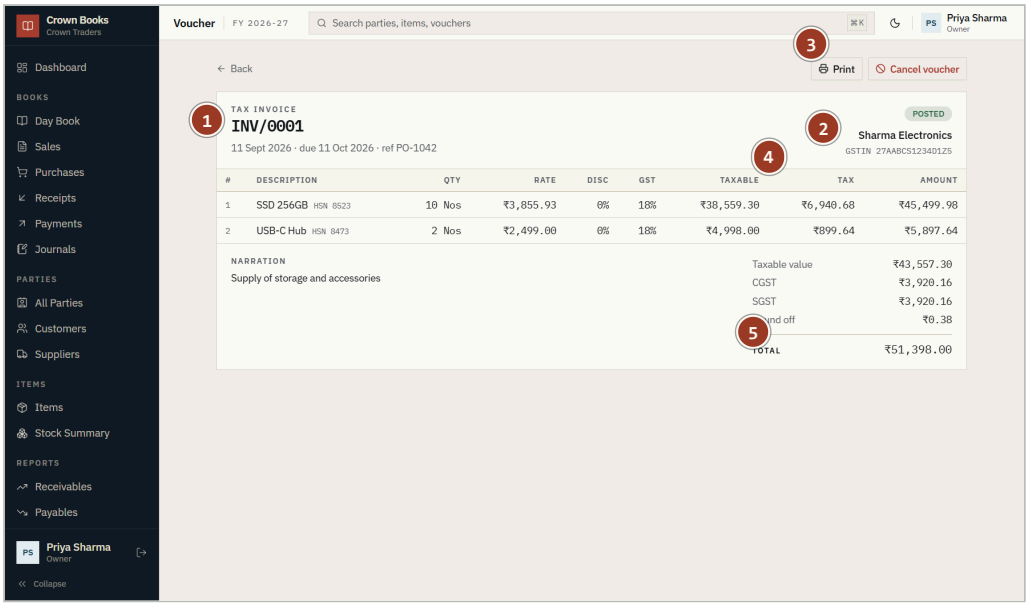


Figure 6.3 The posted invoice screen. Print and Cancel voucher are at the top.

1. Invoice number, date and due date
2. Customer and GSTIN
3. Print, or save as PDF
4. Line detail and tax split
5. Amount due from the customer

6.5 Receipt from a customer

Open **Books** → **Receipts** and click **New receipt**. A receipt can settle one invoice, several invoices, or stay on account as an advance.



1 Click **Receipts** in the sidebar. 2 Click **New receipt**.

1. **Party.** Choose the customer. The screen shows the current balance.
2. **Date.** The date money was received.
3. **Amount.** The total received.
4. **Method** and **Reference.** UPI, NEFT, cheque or cash, and the reference number.
5. **Open invoices** lists unpaid invoices with due dates and outstanding amounts.
6. Enter the amount against the invoice in **Allocate**.
7. Check **Received**, **Allocated** and **On account**.
8. Click **Post receipt**.

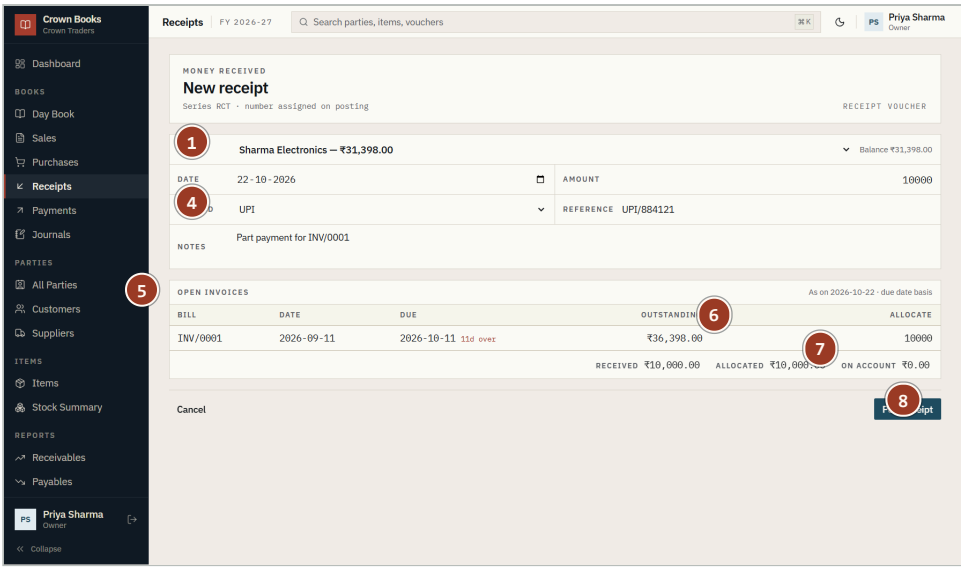


Figure 6.4 A customer receipt. 10,000 is received and allocated to INV/0001.

Advances and part payments. A receipt larger than the open invoice leaves the excess on account. A receipt with no allocation is an advance. When the next invoice is posted, use a new receipt, or adjust the advance through a journal if your accountant prefers.

6.6 Receivables and ageing

Open **Reports** → **Receivables** for the customer totals, and **Reports** → **Ageing** for the age buckets.

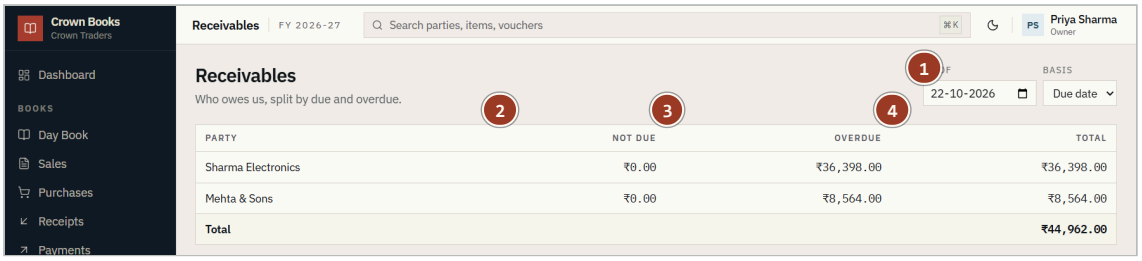


Figure 6.5 Receivables as on 22 October 2026. The overdue column is the money to chase first.

1. As-of date
2. Not yet due
3. Overdue amount
4. Total owed by each customer

Receivables shows not yet due and overdue per customer. Ageing splits the overdue amount into 30-day buckets. Use **Basis** to age by due date (default) or bill date; a bill not yet due stays in Not due even if the invoice is old.

Ageing by party

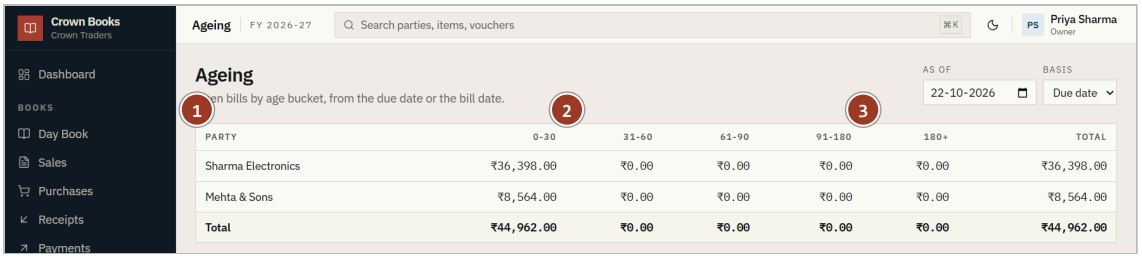


Figure 6.6 Bills are grouped into 0–30, 31–60, 61–90, 91–180 and 180+ days.

1. Ageing by party
2. Thirty-day buckets
3. Chase the oldest first

> **WHO TO CHASE FIRST**
>
> Start with the largest amount in 61–90 and 91–180, not the largest total. Then check 31–60 for customers who are about to become a bigger problem. A 180+ balance needs a decision: collect, write off, or ask the accountant.

6.7 Sales register

The sales register lists every invoice in a period with taxable value, GST, round off and total. It is the first check before a GST return or a management review.

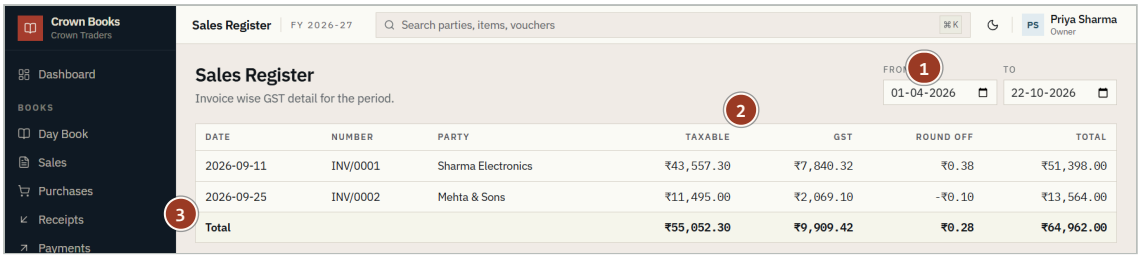


Figure 6.7 The sales register for the financial year, with the period total at the bottom.

1. From and To dates
2. Taxable value and GST per invoice
3. Period totals

- [ ] Every invoice in the period is present, and none is cancelled by mistake.
- [ ] The total GST agrees with the output tax in the trial balance.

07 Adjustments and corrections

The books keep a history. A mistake is corrected by cancelling the voucher and entering a new one, or by posting a journal. Nothing is deleted.

IN THIS CHAPTER Posted means posted · Cancel a voucher · Journal · Contra · Journals list · Ask the accountant

7.1 Posted means posted

A posted voucher is part of the audit trail. You cannot edit its lines, party, date or amount. If it is wrong, cancel it with a reason and enter a fresh voucher. The cancelled voucher stays visible with status CANCELLED, its number is not reused, and its ledger and stock effect is reversed.

7.2 Cancel a voucher

1. Open the voucher from Sales, Purchases, Receipts, Payments, Day Book or a report link.
2. Click **Cancel voucher** at the top right.
3. Enter a **Reason** of at least three characters. “Wrong party” is enough; “test” is not useful.
4. Click **Cancel voucher** in the dialog. The status becomes CANCELLED.
5. Enter the corrected voucher from the beginning.

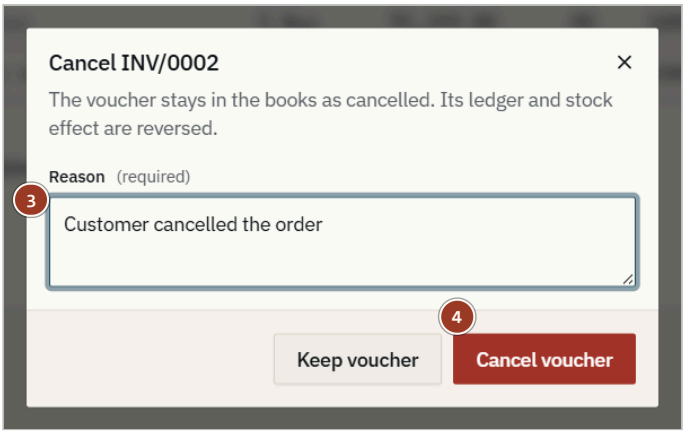


Figure 7.1 Cancelling a voucher. The reason is required; Keep voucher backs out unchanged.

> **DO NOT CANCEL JUST TO HIDE A BILL**
> Cancellation reverses the ledger and stock effect, but the voucher remains in the day book with its reason. It is for corrections, not for removing a real transaction from history.

7.3 Journal

A journal is a manual double entry. Use it for adjustments that are not a sale, purchase, receipt or payment: owner capital, depreciation, an expense paid from cash, or an accountant's correction. Every journal needs at least two lines, and total debits must equal total credits. The screen shows **Balanced** only when they match; **Post** stays disabled until then.



1 Click **Journals** in the sidebar. 2 Click **New journal**.

1. **Date.** The date of the adjustment.
2. **Account** to debit, with the amount. For an expense, debit the expense.
3. **Account** to credit, with the same amount. Usually Cash or Bank.
4. Enter a **Narration** that names the reason.
5. Check that the dialog shows **Balanced**.
6. Click **Post**.

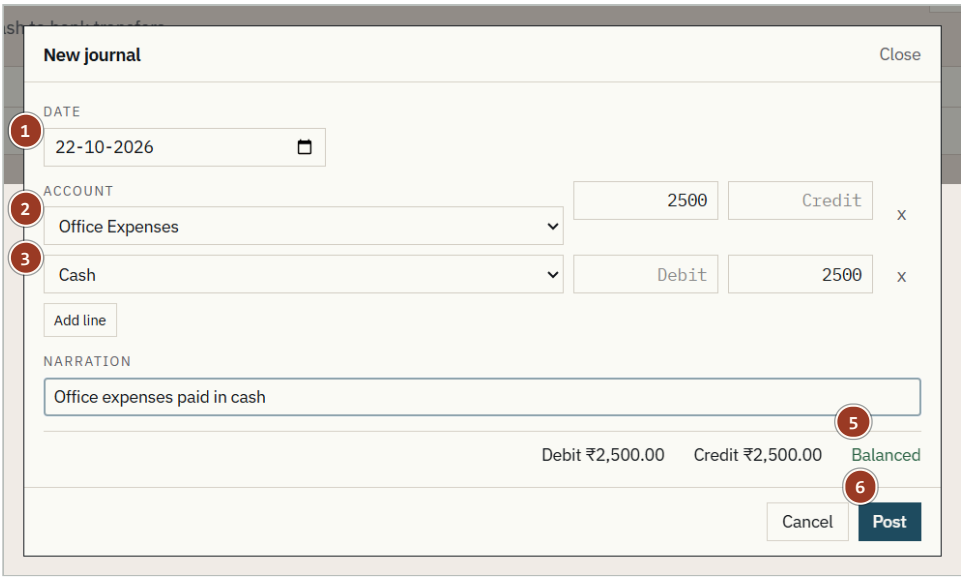


Figure 7.2 A balanced journal: Office Expenses is debited, Cash is credited, both for 2,500.

BEFORE YOU JOURNAL

Write down the two account names and the amount before you open the screen. If you cannot name both accounts, stop and ask the accountant. A journal entered to "see if it works" is harder to clean up than a phone call.

EXAMPLE	DEBIT	CREDIT
Owner introduces capital	Cash	Owner Capital
Office expense paid in cash	Office Expenses	Cash
Depreciation for the month	Depreciation	Accumulated Depreciation
Correct an over-posted expense	The account that was wrongly debited	The expense account

7.4 Contra

A contra moves money between two cash or bank accounts. The common case is depositing cash into the bank. It is not a receipt or a payment, so it does not affect a customer or supplier.



1 Click **Journals** in the sidebar. 2 Click **New contra**.

1. Open **Books** → **Journals** and click **New contra**.
2. Choose the **From account**, usually Cash.
3. Choose the **To account**, usually Bank.
4. Enter the **Date** and **Amount**.
5. Add a **Narration**, for example “Cash deposited into the bank”.
6. Click **Post**.

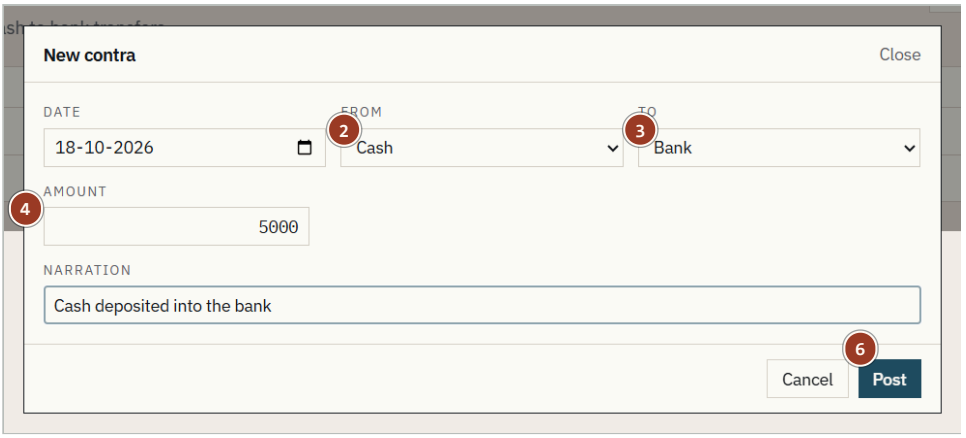


Figure 7.3 A contra for 5,000 from Cash to Bank. The narration explains the transfer.

7.5 The journals list

The **Journals** page lists both manual journals and contra transfers, newest first. The **Type** column tells you which one it is; the **Number** column is the voucher you can quote to your accountant.

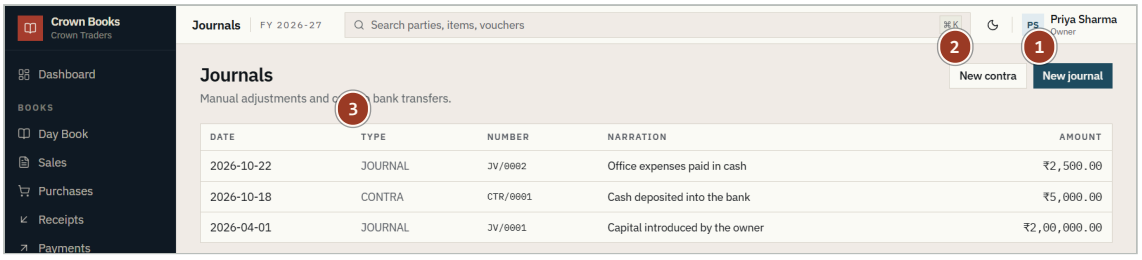


Figure 7.4 Posted journals and contras, with the narration and amount.

1 New manual journal
2 New contra
3 Posted journals and transfers

7.6 When to ask your accountant

- Opening balances do not tie to the old trial balance.
- A GST return is due and the output or input tax looks wrong.
- You need depreciation, prepaid expenses, provisions or any year-end adjustment.
- A party balance is negative or a supplier balance is positive and you cannot explain it.
- The trial balance does not say “Debits equal credits.”

THE MISTAKE	WHAT TO DO
Wrong party, date, item or amount on a posted bill	Cancel it with a reason and enter the correct voucher.
Wrong GST rate or place of supply on a posted invoice	Cancel and re-enter. Do not patch it with a journal; the GST return needs the corrected invoice.
Expense posted to the wrong ledger	Post a journal: debit the correct expense, credit the wrong one.
Owner put money into the business	Journal: debit Cash or Bank, credit Owner Capital.
Cash deposited into the bank	Contra: from Cash, to Bank. Not a receipt or payment.

08 Reports

Reports are reads of posted vouchers. They do not store totals, so a cancelled voucher disappears from the report and a new one appears immediately.

IN THIS CHAPTER How reports work · Day book · Trial balance · Profit and loss · Balance sheet · Report map

8.1 How reports work

Every report reads the posted vouchers for the current company. A cancelled voucher is excluded from the ledger effect. The date controls mean different things:

CONTROL	MEANING
From / To	A period, for example 1 April to 22 October. Used by profit and loss, balance sheet and registers.
As of	A single date. Used by receivables, payables and ageing: what was open on that day.
Basis	Age by due date (default) or by bill date. Due date is better for collection; bill date is better for document age.

> **THREE CHECKS BEFORE YOU TRUST A REPORT**
> Is the voucher posted, not cancelled? Is the date range or as-of date the one you meant? Does the trial balance still say “Debits equal credits”?

8.2 Report map

REPORT	QUESTION IT ANSWERS	WHEN TO USE IT
Receivables	Who owes us, and how much is overdue?	Weekly collection review.
Ageing	How old are the unpaid bills?	Prioritise the oldest debts.
Payables	Who do we owe, and what is due?	Weekly payment run.
Day book	What was posted on a date?	Find a voucher or check an entry.
Sales register	What did we sell, and what GST did we charge?	Before a GST return or a sales review.
Purchase register	What did we buy, and what input GST was recorded?	Before a GST return or a cost review.
Trial balance	Do the books balance?	Month end, before any report is trusted.
Profit and loss	Did we make money this period?	Monthly management review.
Balance sheet	What do we own and owe?	Month end, bank or investor review.

8.3 Day book

The day book lists every voucher in date order, whatever its type. It is the first place to look when you cannot find a document.



Figure 8.1 The day book for October. Click any number to open the voucher.

1. Filter by date, status or text
2. Open the voucher
3. Party and total

The date range defaults to the current month. Change **From** and **To** for an older period, use **Search** for a number or party, and filter by **Status** to see only posted or cancelled documents.

8.4 Trial balance

The trial balance lists every account with a debit or credit balance. If the debit total equals the credit total, the ledger is internally consistent. It does not prove that the business made a profit; it proves that every voucher had two sides.

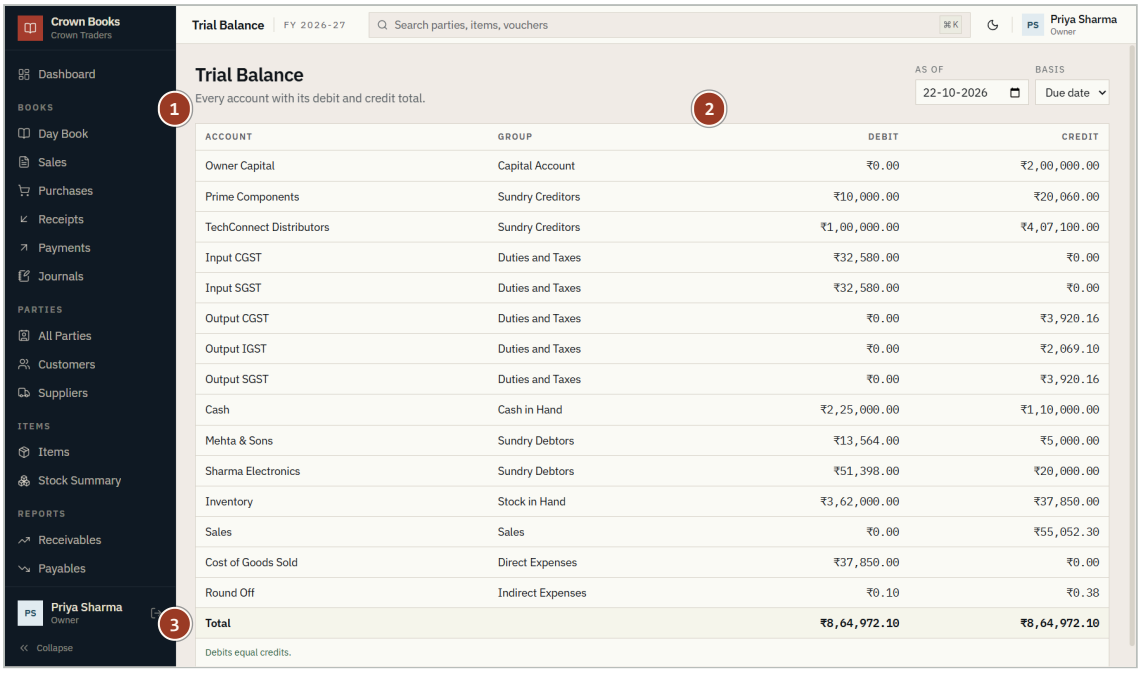


Figure 8.2 The trial balance. The green line at the bottom confirms that debits equal credits.

1. Every account with a balance
2. Debit and credit columns
3. The proof: debits equal credits

Read it by group. Assets and expenses normally sit on the debit side; liabilities, equity and income on the credit side. A party can appear on either side because the balance is net.

8.5 Profit and loss

Profit and loss answers one question: did the business make money in this period? It shows income, expenses and net profit. The period is controlled by **From** and **To**.

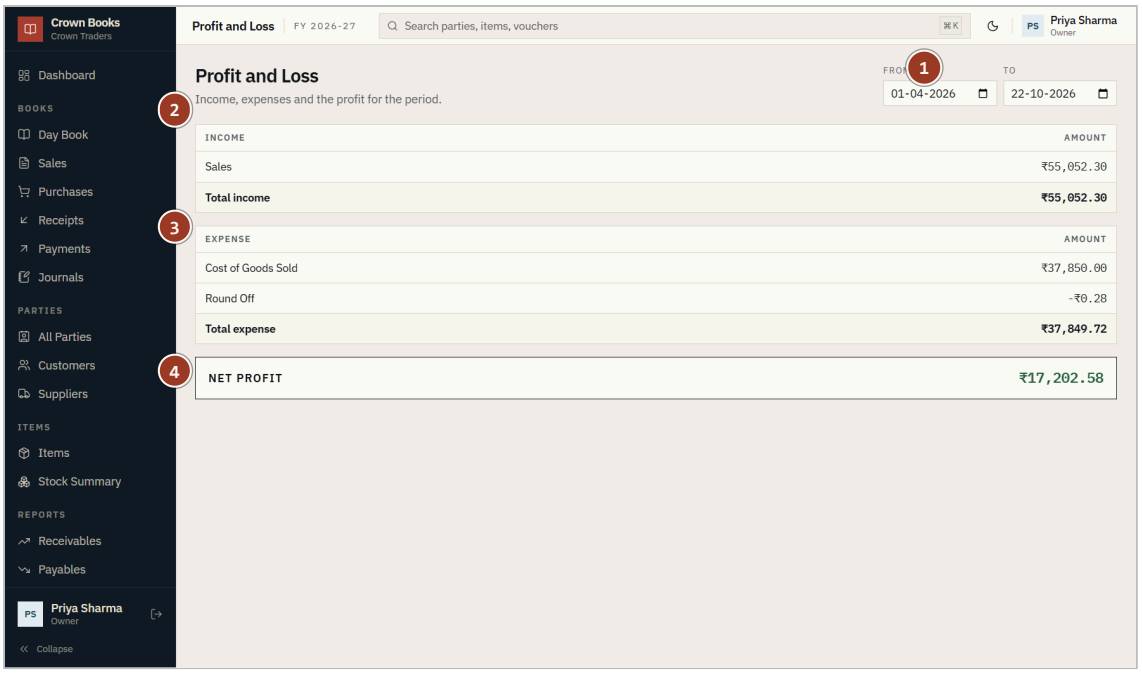


Figure 8.3 Profit and loss for 1 April to 22 October 2026. Cost of goods sold is the cost of the items that were sold.

1. From and To set the period
2. Income accounts
3. Expense accounts
4. Net profit for the period

Sales is shown net of returns. Cost of goods sold is the weighted average cost of the stock that left. Expenses include round off and any journals posted to expense accounts. A loss is shown in red.

8.6 Balance sheet

The balance sheet is a photograph at a date: what the business owns, what it owes, and the owner's stake. It must satisfy **Assets = Liabilities + Equity**.

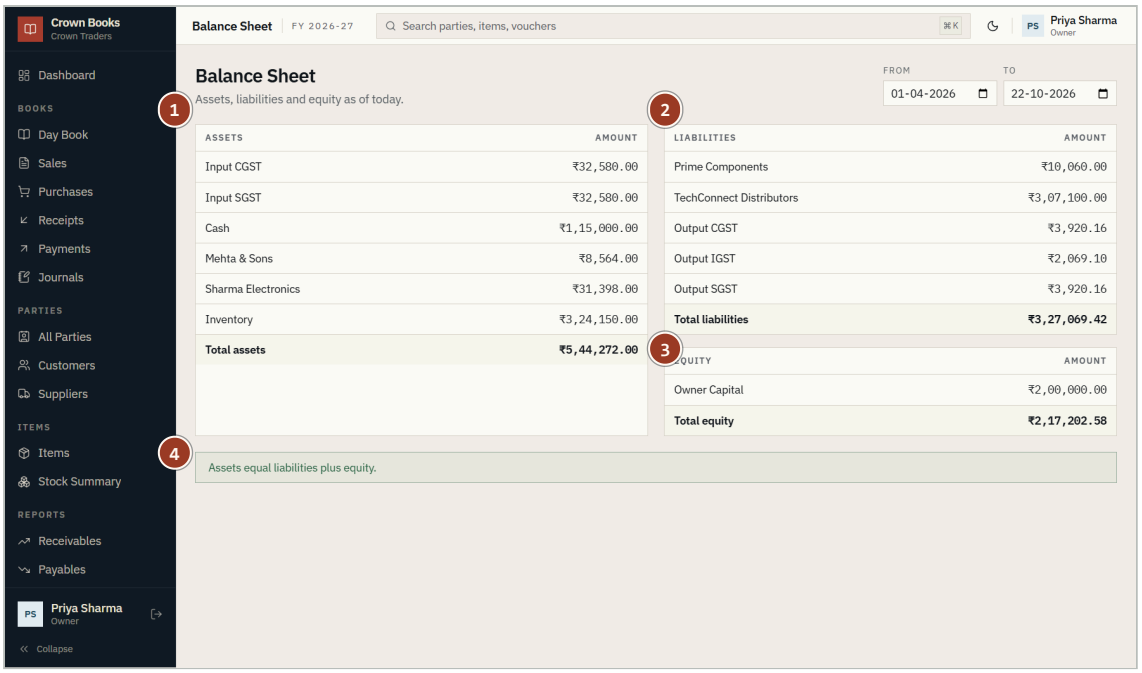


Figure 8.4 The balance sheet. Equity includes owner capital and the current period profit.

1. What the business owns
2. What it owes
3. Owner stake plus current profit
4. The check: assets equal liabilities plus equity

Inventory is valued at weighted average cost. Customer and supplier balances are net. Current period profit is added to equity automatically, so the sheet balances without a manual closing entry.

09 Backup and safety

The books live in one SQLite file on this computer. A backup is a copy of that file. Restore is deliberately manual so that a live database is never swapped underneath the app.

IN THIS CHAPTER Create a backup · Restore · When to back up · Safety rules · This computer only

9.1 Create a backup

Open **Admin → Backup** and click **Create backup**. The app writes a timestamped copy, for example `crown-books-2026-10-22T09-15-00-000Z.db`, into the backup folder next to the database.

1. Click **Create backup**.
2. Confirm the new row in the list. It shows the file name, creation time and size.
3. Copy that file to a different drive or a USB stick. A backup on the same laptop is not enough.

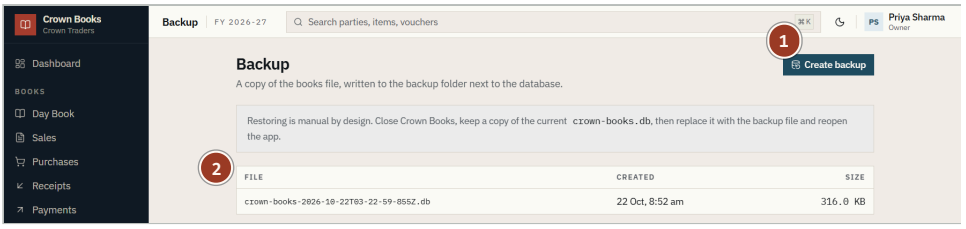


Figure 9.1 The backup screen. Each row is a full copy of the books at that moment.

A backup is a complete copy, not a delta. Restore is done outside the app, with the app closed.

> **CLOSE THE APP FIRST**
> Restoring while Crown Books is open can corrupt the database. Close the app completely, including any window in the taskbar, before replacing the file.

9.2 Restore a backup

1. Create a fresh backup of the current books, even if they are wrong. It is your safety net.
2. Close Crown Books.
3. Open the app data folder. On Windows this is usually `%APPDATA%\crown-books`.
4. Rename the current `crown-books.db` to `crown-books.before-restore.db`.
5. Copy the chosen backup from the backups folder into the app data folder.
6. Rename the copy to `crown-books.db`.
7. Open Crown Books and sign in. Check the dashboard, the trial balance and a recent invoice.

The backup folder is usually `%APPDATA%\crown-books\backups`. If your installation uses a different folder, ask your administrator before moving files.

9.3 When to back up

WHEN	WHY
Before the first real bill	So you can return to an empty, known state.
Every day after posting	The day's work is the most expensive thing to lose.
Before a GST return	Freeze the numbers you are about to file.
Before a restore or upgrade	Keep a copy of the current state even if it is imperfect.
Every Friday, off the machine	Protect against disk failure, theft or ransomware.
At month end	A clean copy for the accountant.

9.4 Safety rules

- [ ] Do not edit the database with another program while Crown Books is open.
- [ ] Do not copy the app folder to another computer. The install lock will refuse to run, and the data may not be the same.
- [ ] Do not restore a backup over a live database. Close the app first.
- [ ] Do not keep every backup on the same laptop. Use a second drive or a USB stick.

9.5 This computer only

Crown Books is offline by design. There is no cloud sync, no remote login and no automatic off-site copy. That is a feature for privacy and a risk for disaster recovery. The backup routine is the disaster recovery plan.

> **THE 3-2-1 RULE, IN PLAIN LANGUAGE**
>
> Keep **3 copies**, on **2 different kinds of storage**, with **1 copy off the computer**. For a small shop, that can be the live database, a daily backup on the laptop, and a weekly copy on a USB drive kept elsewhere.

Backup log

Print this page or keep a note in the shop. A backup is only real when someone has checked that it opens and contains the right day's work.

DATE	FILE NAME	KEPT WHERE	CHECKED BY

10 Reference

Shortcuts, numbering, messages, the words your accountant uses, and the routine that keeps the books clean.

IN THIS CHAPTER Shortcuts · Voucher series · Messages · Glossary · Routines · Not in this edition · Help

10.1 Keyboard shortcuts

SHORTCUT	WHERE	WHAT IT DOES
`Alt + A`	Sales and purchase entry	Adds a new line.
`Ctrl + Enter`	Sales and purchase entry	Posts the voucher.
`Esc`	Sales and purchase entry	Goes back without posting.
`Tab`	Every form	Moves to the next field.
`Ctrl + P`	Voucher detail	Opens the print dialog. The Print button is safer.

10.2 Voucher series and status

SERIES	DOCUMENT	WHAT IT DOES
`INV/`	Sales invoice	Customer owes you; stock goes out; output GST.
`PUR/`	Purchase bill	You owe the supplier; stock comes in; input GST.
`RCT/`	Receipt	Money received from a customer.
`PAY/`	Payment	Money paid to a supplier.
`JV/`	Journal	Manual adjustment; debits must equal credits.
`CTR/`	Contra	Cash to bank or bank to cash.
`OPN/`	Opening	The one-time opening balances voucher.
`CN/ · DN/`	Credit / debit note	Reserved routes; not exposed as a screen.

Status is either POSTED or CANCELLED. Posted documents count in reports. Cancelled documents stay visible but their ledger and stock effect is reversed. A number is never reused.

10.3 Messages and fixes

MESSAGE OR SYMPTOM	WHAT IT MEANS AND WHAT TO DO
“Debits equal credits.”	The trial balance is consistent. No action.
“The books do not balance.”	Stop. Take a backup and ask your accountant; do not post more entries to hide it.
“Opening balances have already been posted”	Only one opening voucher is allowed. Use a journal for corrections.
“Choose customer, supplier, or both”	The party role is missing. Edit the party while it is being created; roles are fixed after saving.
“GSTIN must be 15 characters”	Count the characters. Remove spaces and dashes.
“State code: two digits”	Use 27, not “Maharashtra” or “MH”.
“Password must be at least 8 characters”	Use a longer password. There is no email reset in this edition.
“This computer is not authorised”	The install lock does not match. Contact your administrator; do not copy the app from another PC.
The invoice is not in the list	Check the date range. Lists default to the current month.
The report is empty	Check the As of or From/To dates, and confirm the voucher is Posted, not Cancelled.

10.4 Glossary

WORD	PLAIN MEANING
Receivable	Money a customer owes you.
Payable	Money you owe a supplier.
Debtor	The customer side of receivables.
Creditor	The supplier side of payables.
Debit (Dr)	One side of every entry. A customer balance in Dr means they owe you.
Credit (Cr)	The other side. A supplier balance in Cr means you owe them.
Ledger	A named account, for example Cash or Sales.
Voucher	Any posted document: invoice, bill, receipt, payment, journal or contra.
Narration	The note on the voucher that explains it.
Allocation	Linking a receipt or payment to the bill it settles.

WORD	PLAIN MEANING
On account	Money received or paid that is not yet linked to a bill.
Ageing	How old unpaid bills are, in 30-day buckets.
HSN / SAC	The GST classification code for goods / services.
CGST / SGST	The two halves of GST on a sale inside one state.
IGST	GST on a sale across state lines.
COGS	Cost of goods sold: what the items you sold cost you.
Opening balance	The position brought forward on the first day of the books.
Contra	A transfer between cash and bank.
Journal	A manual adjustment with matched debits and credits.
Trial balance	Every account balance, used to prove debits equal credits.

10.5 Daily, weekly and monthly routine

WHEN	DO THIS
Every day	Post today's sales invoices and supplier bills. Enter receipts and payments, with allocations. Create a backup at the end of the day.
Every week	Chase the oldest overdue bills. Plan the week's payments. Check stock below reorder level. Copy the latest backup off the machine.
Every month	Check that the Trial Balance says "Debits equal credits." Compare Profit and Loss with last month. Explain any large Balance Sheet movement. Create a month-end backup for the accountant.
Every year	Confirm the financial year start month. Take a full backup before the first entry. Ask the accountant about closing journals and depreciation.

10.6 Not active in this edition

These items appear in the navigation or in a form but are reserved or only partly wired. Do not build a process around them yet.

ITEM	STATUS IN THIS EDITION
Global search	Reserved. Use the search field on each page.
Tax Rates / Units	Reserved screens. GST rates are chosen on the item; units are seeded.
Users and Roles	Reserved. The owner account is the only active user.
Credit / debit notes	Routes exist but no screen is exposed. Cancel and re-enter for now.
Excel export	Not available. Use the on-screen report and the print dialog.
Bank reconciliation	Not available. Use the registers and your accountant's filing tool.
Invoice terms	Saved in Company settings but not printed by the current layout.
Payment method	A label only; receipts and payments post to Cash. Use Contra to move to Bank.

10.7 Where to get help

Inside the business

- The owner or administrator for access, installation and backups.
- The accountant for journals, GST, depreciation and year-end entries.
- The backup custodian for the weekly copy kept off the machine.

Before you call

- The voucher number and date, if the problem is a document.
- What you expected and what happened.
- A screenshot of the message, if there is one.
- Whether you have a backup from today.

Revision history

EDITION	DATE	CHANGE
1.0	October 2026	First edition, covering setup, masters, purchases, sales, receipts, payments, stock, journals, reports and backup.